Lesson 3 · Data tables and the Human Development Index

Name: _____ Class: _____ Date: _____

Learning intention: We are learning to read data tables accurately and to use indicators such as the HDI to compare human wellbeing between countries.
Success criteria: □ I can identify the highest or lowest value and name the country. □ I can calculate a difference and include the unit. □ I can explain why an indicator is useful. □ I can explain a limitation of national averages.

We do: Japan, Vietnam, Papua New Guinea and Chad

Human development in four countries, 2023

Country	HDI value (rank out of 193)	Life expectancy (years)	Expected years of schooling	Income per person (US$, adjusted for cost of living)
Japan	0.925 (23rd)	84.7	15.5	47,775
Vietnam	0.766 (93rd)	74.6	15.5	13,033
Papua New Guinea	0.576 (160th)	66.1	11.5	3,971
Chad	0.416 (190th)	55.1	8.3	1,748

Source: UNDP, Human Development Report 2025, Table 1 (data for 2023).

(a) **Identify** the country with the highest life expectancy. *(1 mark)*

(b) **Calculate** the difference in income per person between Japan and Papua New Guinea. Include the unit. *(1 mark)*

(c) **Explain** why expected years of schooling is useful for comparing wellbeing. *(2 marks)*

Expected years of schooling measures _____, which matters because _____. For example, children in Japan can expect _____ years compared with _____ in Chad.

(d) **Explain** why Vietnam's average figures may not show the wellbeing of everyone in Vietnam. *(2 marks)*

You do: New Zealand, Fiji, Nepal and Somalia

Human development in four countries, 2023

Country	HDI value (rank out of 193)	Life expectancy (years)	Expected years of schooling	Income per person (US$, adjusted for cost of living)
New Zealand	0.938 (17th)	82.1	19.3	47,260
Fiji	0.731 (111th)	67.3	13.8	12,843
Nepal	0.622 (145th)	70.4	13.8	4,726
Somalia	0.404 (192nd)	58.8	7.5	1,475

Source: UNDP, Human Development Report 2025, Table 1 (data for 2023).

(a) **Identify** the country with the lowest life expectancy. *(1 mark)*

(b) **Calculate** the difference in life expectancy between New Zealand and Somalia. Include the unit. *(1 mark)*

(c) **Explain** why income per person is useful for comparing wellbeing between countries. *(2 marks)*

(d) **Explain** why an average for a whole country may not show the wellbeing of everyone who lives there. *(2 marks)*

Extension: Nepal has a lower HDI than Fiji, but a higher life expectancy. Explain how this can happen.

You do: scaffolded version

(a) Find the life expectancy column. The lowest value is _____. That country is _____.

(b) _____ − _____ = _____ _____ ← the unit

(c) Complete the frame.

Income per person measures _____, which matters because it shows what people can afford, such as _____. For example, the average income in New Zealand is US$ _____ but in Somalia it is US$ _____.

(d) Complete the frame.

An average gives one number for the whole country, so it hides differences between _____. For example,

_____.

rich and poor | cities and rural areas | regions | men and women | housing | food | healthcare

Exit ticket (or use a sticky note): **Calculate** the difference in expected years of schooling between New Zealand (19.3) and Somalia (7.5). Include the unit.

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